

Speaking

My Life Before This Moment

Pairs · 8-10 min

Tell your partner about three things that had already happened in your life before you started this school year, using the Past Perfect.

Useful language: By the time I started this year, I had already..., Before that, I had never..., I had just... when..., It was the first time I had ever...

1. Think of three events or achievements from your life before this school year began.
2. Prepare one or two sentences about each event using the Past Perfect.
3. Take turns telling your partner your three events; your partner listens and asks one follow-up question about each.
4. Swap roles so both partners get a turn to speak and to ask questions.

The Place I Remember

Groups of 3-4 · 10 min

Describe a memorable place from your past to your group, explaining what it had looked like and what had happened there before it changed or before you left it.

Useful language: The place I remember most is..., Before it changed, it had been..., I had spent a lot of time there because..., By the time I last saw it, it had already...

1. Think of a place from your past (a house, a school, a neighbourhood) that has changed or that you no longer visit.
2. Note down two or three details about what the place had been like and what had happened there.
3. Describe the place to your group, using the Past Perfect where appropriate to show earlier events.
4. Group members ask one question each about the place after the description.

Writing

A Memorable Day

120-150 words

Write a short narrative about a memorable day in your past, making it clear what had already happened before the main event of the day.

Plan:

1. Choose the memorable day you will write about.
2. List two or three things that had already happened before the main event of that day.
3. Decide on the order of events and which time expressions to use.
4. Write a short paragraph, then check your verb forms.

Checklist:

- ☐ I used the Past Perfect for actions that happened before the main event.
- ☐ I used at least two time expressions correctly.
- ☐ My paragraph has a clear order of events.
- ☐ I checked my spelling and past participle forms.

A Short Biography

130-160 words

Write a short biography paragraph about a real or imaginary person, describing what they had achieved or experienced earlier in their life before a key turning point.

Plan:

1. Choose the person and the turning point in their life you will focus on.
2. Note down two or three things that had happened in their life before that turning point.
3. Organise the events in a logical time order.
4. Write the paragraph and then proofread it for correct tense use.

Checklist:

- ☐ I clearly described what had happened before the turning point.
- ☐ I used the Past Perfect and Simple Past correctly together.
- ☐ I included at least three pieces of theme vocabulary.
- ☐ My biography paragraph is within the word limit.